

1972

MUNICH FIRINGS

The 1972 Munich Olympics, which was called the “Cheerful Games” ended up turning into a tragedy. In the second week of the tournament, 11 members of the Israeli Olympic squad and a policeman were killed by members of the Palestinian Black September Organisation.

The Games were suspended within hours of the attack. But the IOC President Avery Brundage instructed that the Games must continue once things are brought to control despite the death of the athletes.

1976

TAIWAN, PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA BOYCOTT THE GAMES

Canada initially did not allow the Republic of China's team (Taiwan) into the country as it did not recognise Taiwan as a nation. Canada's decision was in violation of its agreement with the IOC to allow all recognised teams to compete in the country.

Later on, Canada agreed to allow the Taiwanese athletes into the country if they did not compete under the name or flag of the Republic of China. Other competing countries including the U.S. threatened to boycott the event.

However, all of this came to an end after the IOC agreed to Canada's demand. This led to Taiwan boycotting the Games. The People's Republic Of China also boycotted the Games due to the IOC not recognising them as the sole representative of China.

ANGEL MATOS ATTACKS REFEREE

Cuban taekwondo athlete Angel Matos was banned for life from all international events after kicking a referee in the face during the bronze medal match in Beijing. Matos, a former Olympic gold medallist, suffered a foot injury during the match. He took a timeout but failed to return to the arena within the allotted time, resulting in the referee disqualifying him for a time violation.

Matos argued with the referee, kicked him in the face, punched a judge in the arm, and spat on the floor of the arena before being escorted out by security. The IOC gave him a lifetime ban after this incident.



2016

RUSSIAN ATHLETES BANNED FOR DOPING

The World Anti-Doping Agency's (WADA) series of investigations, which took place post doping allegations during the 2014 Winter Olympics, resulted in the ban of its Russian wing RUSADA for non-compliance to the World Anti-Doping Code.

Out of the 389 athletes in Russia's Olympic squad for the Rio Olympics, 111 athletes were expelled for doping, one day prior to the opening ceremony.